

Chapter 45-8

//

Monday was a sunny day.

Haicheng City, which had been raining for several days, was sunny again, and the weather forecast announced the end of many days of continuous rain, welcoming rising temperatures.

Sunshine improved people's moods.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu got up on time to have breakfast in the morning. One was responsible for making breakfast, the other for cleaning up—division of labor, very harmonious.

Both tactfully avoided mentioning last night's events.

In the morning, Liang Shi asked Xu Qingzhu if she needed to be driven to work. Xu Qingzhu spun the keychain on her finger, "I'll drive myself."

Liang Shi didn't insist, but just before getting in the car, Xu Qingzhu suddenly said, "Congratulations, Liang Shi, on successfully getting the role."

Liang Shi was dazed, "Didn't we talk about it last night?"

Xu Qingzhu smiled, "Saying it in person is more sincere."

Liang Shi was amused and in a great mood, "Thank you, Teacher Xu. Do you have time this Saturday?"

"For what?" Xu Qingzhu didn't immediately agree, "It's not that day yet, don't know if I'll have to work overtime."

Liang Shi: "I'd like to invite you to a concert, to cultivate our temperament."

Then she added, "Mainly to cultivate mine."

—Actually, it was to complete the task.

Xu Qingzhu thought for a few seconds, "We'll see when the time comes. I should be available."

Liang Shi didn't push her: "No problem, we'll talk about it then."

The cars left the villa one after the other.

Meanwhile, at the Liang family's old mansion.

Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe had both gone to work, and Sun Meirou had taken Ling Dang to school.

Liang Zu was about to go out for business talks and was still at home watching the news. Qiu Zimin hesitated several times, wanting to speak.

Liang Zu noticed her strange behavior and looked at her several times, but she didn't speak.

When Liang Zu was about to leave, Qiu Zimin finally called out to him, "Honey, wait."

"What is it?" Liang Zu asked.

Qiu Zimin sighed heavily, "Let's go upstairs to talk."

Liang Zu raised his hand to check his watch, "Make it brief."

After returning to their room, Qiu Zimin carefully closed the door, then said carefully, "Master Yunyin¹ contacted me."

"What about?" Liang Zu frowned.

"He said Liang Shi's fate pattern has changed now. The original formation can't suppress her anymore, so it's starting to backfire on the Liang family. Think about it—wasn't the loss of that southern district land because of her?" Qiu Zimin said.

Liang Zu asked, "So what should we do? Remove the formation?"

Qiu Zimin nodded, "She's just a useless pawn to us now. Her fate pattern can't help Dongheng anymore. After removing the formation..."

She didn't finish the sentence, but Liang Zu said, "But we still have to support her. After all, she's publicly the Liang family's daughter."

"But we've been supporting her all these years, always cleaning up after her." Qiu Zimin suddenly choked up, "Our own daughter is still wandering somewhere unknown, yet we have to raise someone else's child."

"Her fate pattern did help the Liang family prosper for a while." Liang Zu patted her shoulder consolingly, "If it were our own daughter, we certainly wouldn't bear to give her up. Just consider it a transaction of interests. Besides, haven't we been looking for our daughter all these years? If we can't find her, what can we do?"

Qiu Zimin sniffled, "A few days ago, Dongling City cracked down on a human trafficking ring. Many children were reunited with their families. Watching the news always makes me think of our third daughter². If she were still at home, how wonderful that would be.

"All these years, I've just felt I owe our daughter. Having an unrelated girl in our house, with Xinzhou and Xinhe doting on her so much—if our daughter were here, she would definitely be loved and spoiled by her two brothers. Now, who knows in what remote place she's suffering."

Liang Zu sighed, "It's all my fault for not watching her carefully back then."

"Don't say that." Qiu Zimin immediately said, "When bad people want to commit crimes, what can we do? If we're talking blame, I'm also responsible for not taking good care of our daughter."

"About Liang Shi..." Liang Zu frowned, "If it's not too harmful, let's keep supporting her. Even if we really find our daughter, we can't just throw her out—what would that make the Liang family?"

But Qiu Zimin shook her head, "That's not possible."

Liang Zu was puzzled, "What's wrong?"

Qiu Zimin bit her lip, looking troubled, then sighed heavily with an expression of reluctance but necessity, "Master Yunyin said that now that Liang Shi's fate pattern has changed, if she continues to stay in our home, our family will suffer backlash. Look what she's become now."

"Her personality has improved a lot." Liang Zu said, "Her abilities are also stronger than before. Xinhe says she's performing very well at the company—she's promising material."

"Exactly." Qiu Zimin said, "Her fate pattern conflicts with our family's. After she improved, our family will surely decline from prosperity. What's the point of keeping her? Business is already difficult now. If we continue to keep her..."

Liang Zu also became anxious, "What will happen?"

Qiu Zimin shook her head, "Master Yunyin said it will inevitably cause endless trouble."

Liang Zu took a sharp breath, "That's not acceptable! The family business my father built with his own hands must not be ruined in mine."

Qiu Zimin's eyes filled with tears, saying helplessly, "Although she's not my child, I raised her with my own hands. Everyone knows I love this child the most. Now, like this, I can't bear it either. Moreover, Master Yunyin said we can't quietly send her away, or there will still be backlash. We must completely cut ties with her and can't provide any help."

Liang Zu was troubled, "That's too..."

"There's no choice." Qiu Zimin sighed, "Who told her that her fate pattern conflicts with our family's?"

Seeing Liang Zu still hesitating, Qiu Zimin continued, "But this is good too. If heaven blesses us one day and our little girl³ comes back, knowing that during her absence we were loving someone else, she would definitely be heartbroken."

Liang Zu was convinced. He closed his eyes, "Then we have no choice."

Then he asked, "What about those things in Liang Shi's room..."

Qiu Zimin said, "Don't worry. Following the master's guidance, I had them disposed of early and had her room repainted. There's definitely no trace left. This kind of thing can't be known by others—I understand."

Liang Zu nodded, "Right. The Lin family somehow got wind of something. A few days ago, Old Lin even asked me if we had replaced Liang Shi's soul. I was startled and deflected."

Qiu Zimin comforted him, "No one will know. Even if they knew, no one would believe it. Besides, it was just changing a fate pattern—where's the soul replacement? Pure nonsense."

Liang Zu: "Speaking of which, Liang Shi's fate pattern is really strong. Even after becoming like that, she could recover to her current state. To tell you the truth, when she looked at me during dinner last time, I kept thinking of when she was little—such a well-behaved and beautiful little girl, didn't talk much, but her eyes had spirit."

Liang Zu spoke with a nostalgic tone. Qiu Zimin immediately said, "Ah, if our little girl were here, she would definitely be like that too. Wonder how our little girl has been doing all these years."

Liang Zu thought of his third daughter who had been missing for years and sighed helplessly, "Yes, I also wonder how our little girl is doing."

After chatting for a while longer, Liang Zu asked, "So how should we cut ties with Liang Shi? If something like this suddenly happens, I'm afraid it will harm Dongheng."

Qiu Zimin smiled confidently, "The master has pointed out a clear path for this."

She whispered the method in his ear. After hearing it, Liang Zu couldn't help but admire, "Truly worthy of being a master—really brilliant!"

Qiu Zimin smiled gently, but finally felt relieved inside.

What to do with disobedient children?

Abandon them, of course.

She wanted to see what would become of Liang Shi without the Liang family's support.

Did she really think she had grown up and could spread her wings?

Heh.

Still too naive.

Footnotes: ¹ Master Yunyin: A Taoist master/fortune teller that the Liang family consults, literally means "Cloud Hidden" ² Third daughter: In Chinese families, children are often referred to by birth order. The "third daughter" refers to their biological daughter who was kidnapped ³ Little girl: An affectionate term for their missing daughter